



Rajiv Goswami, a final-year student in Delhi University, immolating himself on September 15 to protest the implementation of the Mandal Commission recommendations. He died in 2004.

"BJP HAS PUT SECULARISM IN PROPER PERSPECTIVE."

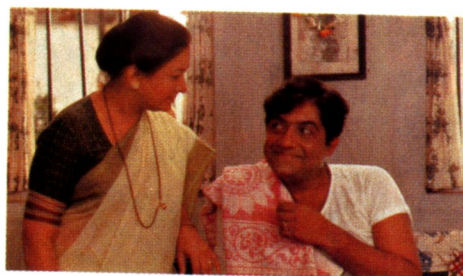
Lal Krishna Advani

When L.K. Advani stepped into his rath at Somnath, the temple of his dreams 10,000 km and 30 days away, he sent out the BJP's most audacious message to the people of India, associating itself with the RSS-VHP line, that construction on the Ram Temple would begin on October 30 no matter what. In a final showdown, the BJP withdrew support to the V.P. Singh Government.



TELE-REALISM

The show *Wagle ki Duniya*, based on a character by cartoonist R.K. Laxman, was aired on Doordarshan at a time when television sets had already found their way into over two-thirds of India's homes. In the days of staid *sarkari* programming, people instantly connected with lead actors Anjan Srivastava and Bharti Achrekar's middle-class muddles.



ELSEWHERE

- Nelson Mandela (below) was released from Victor Verster Prison, near Cape Town, South Africa, where he had been imprisoned for 27 years.
- US President George W. Bush and Soviet Union leader Mikhail Gorbachev signed a treaty to stop manufacturing chemical weapons and began reducing stocks. Iraq invaded Kuwait,

AP



leading to the Gulf War.

- Establishing the first ground link between the United Kingdom and mainland Europe since the Ice Age, Channel Tunnel workers from the UK and France met 40 metres beneath the English Channel seabed.

Rs 500

was the value of just one kilogram of Darjeeling tea in auctions for exports on April 30. India is the world's largest producer of tea—almost all of the fine Darjeeling tea is exported, the major buyers being Russia, Iran and Iraq.